



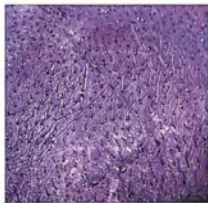
HIPPOS, PIGS, AND PECCARIES



Hippo is short for hippopotamus, which means “river horse.” They are called river horses because they live in rivers and lakes, and eat grass. Pigs and peccaries do not live in rivers, but they enjoy wallowing in mud as much as their huge relatives. Although these water-loving mammals are not carnivores, they are all able to protect themselves. Wild pigs can stab and kill tigers with their tusks, peccaries fight jaguars, and a heavy hippo will tussle with a crocodile or smash into a boat!



Very important pig
Farmyard pigs have all been bred from wild boars.



Built-in suntan lotion

Hippo skin oozes tiny blobs of pink liquid. This oil stops their skin from drying out and also protects them from sunburn.

Open wide

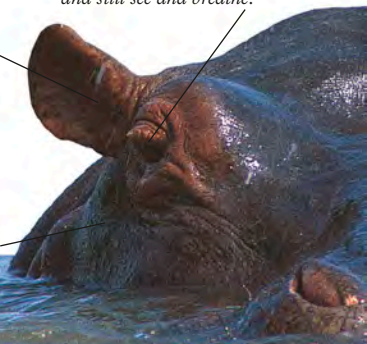
You yawn when you are tired or bored, but male hippos yawn when they are angry! Smaller males are frightened off by the big teeth and swim away without starting a fight.



The 1.5 feet-long (half meter) tusks are sometimes used to stab crocodiles.

Smooth, almost hairless, skin.

The eyes and nostrils are high up on a hippo's head. This means it can stick just the top of its head out of the water and still see and breathe.



Hippos are 5 feet (1.5 meters) tall. They live in Africa.



This big male hippo weighs as much as 120 eight-year-old children!

